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Final Portfolio Defense

WHAT IT MEANS TO THINK STRAIGHT

Purpose: Construct and test a defense of intellectual growth using Whately, at least three portfolio artifacts, one revision, one Shakespeare application, and one concrete transfer.

Part 1: Definition and Thesis

Question 1.1

Define *disciplined thinker* through observable habits. Include at least three accurate Whately habits and one limit on what logic can do.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

Write the controlling claim of your defense. State a specific pattern of growth that your portfolio can prove; do not claim perfection or mere completion.

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Artifact Evidence

Question 2.1

Present Artifact 1. Identify it, describe or quote the relevant reasoning, name the logical habit, and explain how it supports your thesis.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Present Artifact 2 using the same evidence-and-commentary standard. This artifact must show a different stage or kind of reasoning from Artifact 1.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 2 Continued: Required Artifacts

Question 2.3

Present Artifact 3. Across Questions 2.1–2.3, at least one artifact must be substantively revised and at least one must use *Macbeth* or *Julius Caesar*. Identify those requirements explicitly.

Part 2 Q3

Question 2.4

State the warrant connecting each artifact to the pattern in your thesis. Explain why these are evidence of growth rather than isolated correct answers.

Part 2 Q4

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Part 3: Test the Defense

Question 3.1

Name one counterpressure: a remaining weakness, contrary artifact, or fair objection to your thesis. Then qualify the thesis so it remains accurate without becoming empty.

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

Use the Shakespeare artifact as a judgment mirror. Identify the character's pressure point and explain which disciplined habit the passage makes necessary; avoid plot summary and moral boasting.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Transfer and Closing Defense

Question 4.1

Make one concrete transfer claim. Name a setting beyond this unit, a likely reasoning pressure, and the exact action you will take because of one Whately habit.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

Write the closing paragraph or oral-defense notes. Restate the qualified thesis, synthesize the three artifacts, and answer: What does it mean to think straight?

Part 4 Q2

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Part 4 Continued: Final Logic Check

Question 4.3

Audit your own defense. Identify one place where terms, evidence, inference, source judgment, rhetoric, or qualification still needs attention, and write the exact revision you will make.

Part 4 Q3

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Part 5: Review

Question 5.1

An early portfolio caption says, “I changed my answer, so this proves I became a disciplined thinker.” Use the Week 18 revision standard to name what evidence the caption still needs.

Part 5 Q1

Question 5.2

A debater admits privately, “I chose the policy first,” but tells the audience, “Only an enemy of safety would question this plan.” Use a prior-week tool to identify the pressure point and one narrower honest claim.

Part 5 Q2